
NEWS

San Francisco Keeps Its Flock Cameras, With New Restrictions

The tighter rules are meant to strengthen privacy protections while doubling down on the controversial surveillance technology.

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By **Jose Velasquez**









San Francisco Mayor Daniel Lurie speaks to members of the press after unveiling the renamed federal building in honor of Senator Dianne Feinstein on June 29, 2026 in San Francisco, California. Mayor Lurie unveiled a new privacy policy for the city's automated licens

As public scrutiny over [Flock Safety cameras](#) mounts, San Francisco officials announced new restrictions and increased oversight on Tuesday for the city's use of license plate readers.

San Francisco Mayor Daniel Lurie joined District Attorney Brooke Jenkins, Police Chief Derrick Lew and Assemblymember Matt Haney to share a raft of new policies intended to strengthen privacy protection

"This technology keeps San Franciscans safe," Lurie said, "and we will not go back to a time where people can break into cars, rob businesses or commit serious crime and expect to get away with it."



An automated

Standing underneath a Flock license plate reader on Mission Street, the mayor credited the cameras with reduced crime and improved public safety, while acknowledging residents “also have a right to expect st

Under the new rules, San Francisco Police Department personnel will lose access to license plate data after 30 days, and officers’ use of the technology must be justified and reported.

Used by thousands of law enforcement agencies throughout the country, the technology has [raised alarms](#) over the potential for misuse and unauthorized sharing of information.

In June, the SFPD revealed that their Automated License Plate Reader, or ALPR, data had been [improperly accessed](#) hundreds of times by out-of-state and federal agencies.

Lurie emphasized on Tuesday that the city doesn't willingly share ALPR data with federal agencies.

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Lurie and Haney said in the announcement that they would also work together to pursue state legislation strengthening penalties for police officers or any public safety personnel who misuse ALPR data or discl

That's after a [San José](#) police officer was fired in April for using the technology to track a civilian who accused his family member of domestic violence. There's currently [no state law preventing officers](#) from r

Assemblymember Matt Haney said the system is broken and that the San José police officer should be criminally charged.

Both Lurie and Jenkins said they're not aware of any instances of police officers in San Francisco misusing Flock cameras. The district attorney called for the city to get ahead of any potential violation to maintain

"Our job isn't to react after something bad happens," Jenkins said.

In a [press release](#), the mayor said SFPD will conduct monthly reviews for potential violations. And the Department of Police Accountability will conduct regular independent audits of the department's use of the cameras. Training will be required for personnel with access to ALPR systems. Officers who violate the new policy face department discipline or termination, the release said.

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